Learn About Being an IT Project Manager

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IT Project Manager Hiring Insights

Average pay

$63.34 / hour

Low $24.20 **High** $200.00

Job seekers

17,974

+138 since August 2026

Employers hiring

625

+625 with open roles this month

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What does an IT project manager do?

An IT project manager administers an organization's information technology initiatives. These professionals, also referred to as IT managers or computer and information systems managers, make a significant contribution to a business' success in IT-related projects by developing technological strategies. Other responsibilities include:

- Working with the company's senior management to evaluate, improve and develop IT strategies and policies for the organization by anticipating needs and considering business goals

- Aligning IT strategies, projects, tasks, hardware and software with business goals to achieve business outcomes
- Improving cybersecurity strategies by doing research, acting proactively to cyber threats and recommending new approaches to senior management
- Managing the computer network infrastructure within an organization by auditing systems, assessing outcomes, recommending improvements and managing changes to the architecture
- Helping senior management with the recruitment, onboarding and training of IT staff members
- Motivating IT employees, communicating expectations, evaluating job performance and ensuring adherence to policies on computer use and cybersecurity
- Scheduling the renewal and upgrade of the company's software programs
- Providing backup systems for company operations, employee access to the network and data security
- Helping to develop IT budgets

Average salary

IT managers are typically full-time employees, though a few may work part-time. Salaries for this position vary based on work experience, education, industry, company size, geographic location and other company-specific factors. For the most up-to-date salary information from Indeed, click on the salary link.

- Common salary in the U.S.: **$100,428 per year**
- Some salaries range from **$31,000 to $178,000 per year.**

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IT project manager requirements

There are several requirements you may need to get a job as an IT project manager, including:

Education

An IT project manager is a mid-level position, so these professionals are expected to have a bachelor's degree in addition to skill certifications and work experience. Many IT project managers hold graduate degrees because some employers may prefer advanced degrees. Those interested in this job can earn degrees in information technology, computer security or a related field. These disciplines prepare professionals for the challenges of working in this position and the IT industry.

Individuals without degrees could seek certifications in network security, cybersecurity or project management. Some employers may accept proportionate or significant work experience and technical certifications in place of education requirements.

Training

IT project managers often learn company-specific technology and techniques on the job. This training is usually included in the onboarding process that could take place during the first month of employment. As this position involves strategic, managerial and operational responsibilities, IT project managers are expected to have at least five years of relevant experience in an entry- or mid-level position. Many companies also prefer applicants with at least two years of experience in an IT managerial position.

Certifications

Several certifications can improve the chances of being hired for this position, provide additional skills and qualifications, and possibly increase earnings, including:

Advanced Security Practitioner (CASP+)

Offered by the Computing Technology Industry Association (CompTIA), this certification teaches, assesses and certifies a candidate's proficiency of practical skills in using, developing and securing enterprise architecture. This certification can assist in a project manager's strategic, managerial and operational responsibilities that often require a practical understanding of enterprise architecture.

Network+

Offered by CompTIA, this certification covers essential areas of network security such as configuration, design, deployment, maintenance and management. An IT project manager must ensure employee access to the network, develop IT policies and help in the development of cybersecurity strategies.

Project Management Professional

Offered by the Project Management Institute, this certification covers the planning, initiation, controlling and closing of projects. An IT project manager meets deliverables by managing teams of IT professionals and IT projects.

Skills

The ideal candidate for this position should have several key skills, including:

Project management

These skills involve using desktop and online project management software to assign tasks, manage timelines and ensure deliverables move through each stage. IT project managers also use organization and time management for planning, scheduling and prioritizing tasks to meet project deliverables.

Technology

These skills involve knowledge of SQL, programming languages, operating systems and VMware. IT project managers use these technologies to research, manage projects and meet goals in web-based operations.

Strategy

IT project managers must be able to evaluate, improve and align IT strategies to business goals. IT managers identify the business impact of enterprise architecture, discover improvements and develop IT strategies that help a company achieve its goals.

Risk management

This skill involves managing risk in network infrastructure and online business platforms. IT project managers use this skill when they make security assessments, identify security controls, and implement security controls to the network.

Communication

IT project managers communicate with both entry-level and senior workers to inform and motivate project stakeholders. They also draft written documentation to report on project deliverables and keep security policies. An IT project manager uses highly developed written communication skills to describe technical concepts, issues and solutions to both non-technical and technical audiences.

IT project manager work environment

These professionals typically work in an office setting that requires the following:

- Spending extended periods sitting at a desk
- Working independently
- Using computers and other office equipment as needed
- Facilitating communication between IT teams and other internal stakeholders

These professionals can work in the IT department of a company in a variety of industries or for an IT company that services clients.

How to become an IT project manager

Follow these steps to become an IT project manager:

1. Gain qualifications

Determine the education requirements and skill certifications that companies commonly require for this position in the geographical areas you want to work. You can also pursue a relevant bachelor's degree and consider earning certifications to expand your qualifications.

2. Acquire work experience

Earn relevant experience by working in entry-level IT professional positions, including a help desk attendant, IT specialist or technician. These experiences can enable you to practice necessary technical and problem-solving skills and can familiarize you with IT project manager responsibilities.

3. Update your resume

Develop a professional resume that highlights your suitability for an IT project manager position by describing your education, training, certifications and skills. Make sure to tailor your resume for the unique responsibilities of each job listing.

4. Apply to job opportunities

After gaining the necessary education, certifications and training, look for open positions where you meet the requirements. Research which companies you want to work for, and write cover letters that highlight your suitability for each position and demonstrate your enthusiasm for the job.

5. Prepare for interviews

Research interview-related information, such as techniques for negotiating salary and frequently asked interview questions for technology and management positions.

IT project manager job description example

Bernard Inc. is seeking an IT project manager for our growing company. In this role, you will be responsible for managing network infrastructure that covers the many departments of our organization. Other responsibilities include:

- *Monitoring and responding to cybersecurity threats*
- *Developing and administering IT policies on computer use, privacy and cybersecurity*
- *Managing IT projects to ensure systems are regularly updated*
- *Training new and current employees on security measures and other necessary tasks*

Candidates must have at least four years of relevant IT experience and two years serving in a management position. Familiarity with programming languages is beneficial. Successful applicants should also have a bachelor's degree in information technology, business or a related field. Master's degrees and certifications may be commensurate with experience.

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